



The Grand Mosque is a landmark of Nouakchott city.

Mauritania



Africa

Desert rock

A singer, poet, and musician, Noura Mint Seymali performs Mauritanian folk music blended with modern rock.

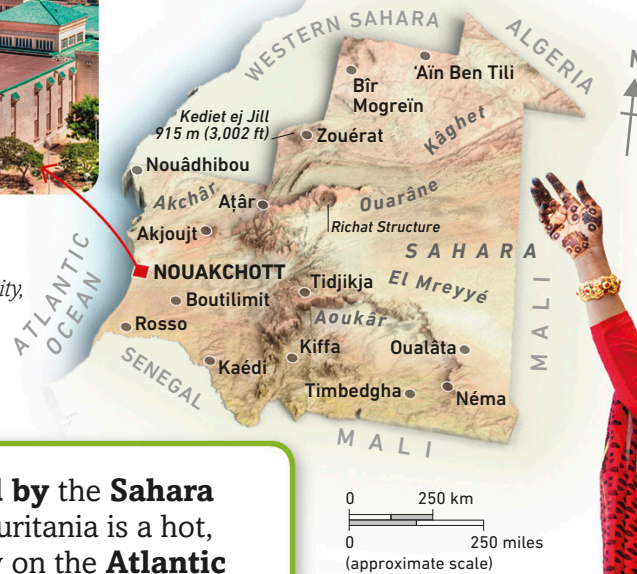
Thriving metropolis

Just a coastal village in 1960, Nouakchott has expanded rapidly to become the nation's main city, with wide boulevards and impressive buildings.

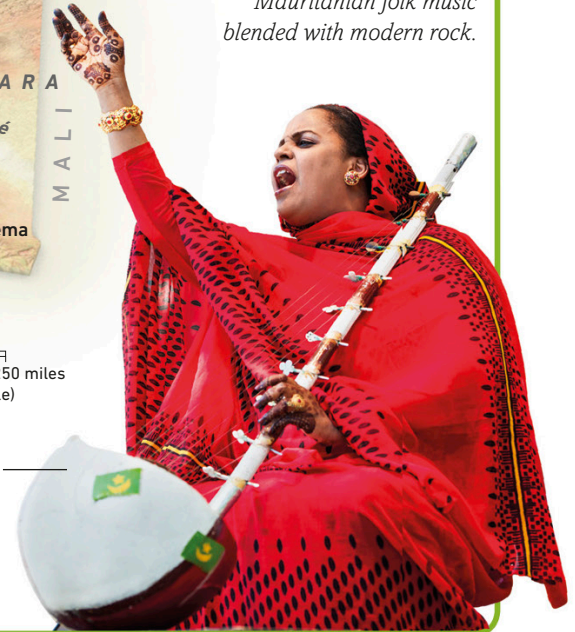


- ☑ 397,955 sq miles (1,030,700 sq km)
- 👤 4 million
- ★ Nouakchott
- 🗣 Arabic, other languages (+3)

Dominated by the Sahara Desert, Mauritania is a hot, arid country on the **Atlantic coastline** of western Africa. Many people in this vast nation are farmers or herders. **Fishing, mining, and oil production** are key industries.



The ardin is a type of Mauritanian harp.



These pyramids were built in the village of Malbaza. Popular with visitors, peanut pyramid-building is being revived.

Peanut pyramids

Peanuts are a major crop in Niger. Sacks of peanuts are piled high to make pyramids, as symbols of prosperity.



- ☑ 489,191 sq miles (1,267,000 sq km)
- 👤 22.8 million
- ★ Niamey
- 🗣 Hausa, Djerma, other languages (+4)

This **Saharan** nation is named after the Niger River, which passes through its capital city, **Niamey**. In rural areas, **nomads** herd and trade **cattle, sheep, goats, and camels**. They live off and sell milk, meat, and hides.



Niger



Communal wells

As there is little rainfall in Niger, nomadic desert people rely on groundwater from wells. Some local tribes unite to build wells shared by the community.

